

Est. 1796 · 95 Counties · 3 Branches • UNITED STATES
GOVERNMENT & CIVICS (GC) • COURSE STANDARD
EDITION

GOVERNMENT HACK™

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES

UNIT 7

Tennessee State and Local Government

COURSE STANDARD EDITION

GC.28–GC.30 • Tennessee U.S. Government & Civics
Standards • Grades 9–12

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

This whole unit is the Tennessee Connection. Foundations traced government in the abstract; here it becomes concrete and local — the Capitol in Nashville, the three Grand Divisions marked by the three stars on the state flag, the ninety-five counties on the state map, and the specific legislators elected from your own district. Tennessee is not an example in this unit; Tennessee is the subject (GC.28–GC.30).

*One common workbook designed for learner variability.
Every student works toward the same Tennessee
standards; supports vary the means, not the goal or the
ceiling.*

Release-Ready · Pilot Edition

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[to be assigned]

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Government Hack™ — Unit 7: Tennessee State and Local Government, Course Standard Edition.

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Source integrity. Every primary source in this unit is public-domain and cited to its holding repository (National Archives, Library of Congress). See the Source Library.

Reading provenance (district-clear). Close-Read passages are labeled “Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis” — they build on the standard record and are not presented as primary sources.

Framework stack. This workbook anchors to Tennessee U.S. Government & Civics standards GC.28–GC.30 and the Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–SSP.06), and is designed on CAST UDL 3.0 and an MTSS support model.

Pacing. Each standard is built for **one 45-minute class period**. Each activity shows a 🕒 ~ **minutes** estimate at its heading. There is more here than one period holds — your teacher chooses which activities you do in class; the rest may become warm-ups, stations, or homework.

Table of Contents

Tennessee Standards & SSP Crosswalk

Each standard below is taught to the full Course Standard expectation; the Social Studies Practices are embedded in every activity cycle.

Standard	Focus	Student Deck slides
GC.28	Tennessee's Three Branches	2-8
GC.29	Local Government in Tennessee	2-8
GC.30	Identify Your Current Officials	2-8

Social Studies Practices (SSP.01-SSP.06)

SSP.01 Gather/evaluate sources · SSP.02 Critically examine a primary source · SSP.03 Synthesize evidence · SSP.04 Construct/communicate argument · SSP.05 Develop historical awareness · SSP.06 Chronological/spatial reasoning. Each Close Read, Primary Source/Data, and CER activity names the practices it builds.

Accessibility, UDL & Accommodations Matrix

One firm learning goal per standard; flexible, universal means. Supports are available by design and never lower the goal. They work alongside — never in place of — required IEP or 504 accommodations.

Universal support	What it is	Where it appears
CORE PATH	Essential instruction every student completes	Every activity
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, Spanish cognates	Word Bank, Guided/Light Backs
RESPONSE CHOICE	Write, say/record, or diagram	Every activity
SUPPORT OPTION	Optional scaffold that keeps the goal	Guided Support Back, Primary Source
PROGRESS CHECK	Quick DOK-2/3 check to guide reteach/extend	Cornell Notes, Practice Quiz
EXTENSION	Deeper challenge once the goal is met	Extension Bank, CER

How CAST UDL 3.0 is visible in this workbook

Multiple means of Engagement (response choice, relevance via Tennessee Connection), Representation (Word Bank, pronunciation, Spanish, Close-Read supports), and Action & Expression (write/say/diagram, Frayer, CER). No fixed-track labels appear.

My Support Plan (optional — you choose)

Supports are available by design. Check the ones you might try; you can change your mind any time.

Support I might use	When it would help me
Word Bank + Spanish column	
Guided or Light Support Back	
Response choice (say/record or diagram)	
Sentence frames / Rehearsal Lab	

How to Use This Workbook

Each standard runs the same seven-activity cycle: (1) Vocabulary Word Bank, (2) Vocabulary Studio, (3) Direct-Teaching Cornell Notes with optional Guided and Light Support Backs, (4) Close Read, (5) Primary Source / Data Analysis, (6) Core Application Practice Quiz, (7) Constructed Response (CER). Work the CORE PATH; reach for SUPPORT OPTIONS as needed.

Label legend — these appear throughout every standard cycle

Label	Meaning
CORE PATH	The essential instruction every student completes.
SUPPORT OPTION	An optional scaffold that keeps the goal, not lowers it.
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, and Spanish cognates for access.
RESPONSE CHOICE	Show learning by writing, saying/recording, or diagramming.
PROGRESS CHECK	A quick DOK-2/3 check that guides reteach or extend.
EXTENSION	A deeper challenge once the goal is met.

Before You Begin — Set a S.M.A.R.T. Goal

Strong learners set goals — but a goal only helps if it is built well. First learn how, then write yours.

WHAT MAKES A GOAL STRONG? Build it S.M.A.R.T.

S — Specific: say exactly what you will be able to do (“explain how a bill becomes law,” not “do well”).

M — Measurable: how will you PROVE it? — a score, a diagram, or teaching a partner.

A — Achievable: a real stretch you can reach with effort — not too easy, not impossible.

R — Relevant: it connects to this unit’s big question.

T — Time-bound: name WHEN — “by the end of this unit.”

SEE THE DIFFERENCE

Weak: “I want to do good in government.” (vague — nothing to measure)

S.M.A.R.T.: “By the end of this unit I can explain how the three branches check each other, and prove it by teaching a partner and scoring 80%+ on the check.”

This unit’s big question: How does Tennessee govern itself at the state and local levels — and how do you take part?

BUILD YOURS — write each piece on the lines, then combine them at the bottom

Fill in each part of your goal. Use the lines.

Part of my goal	Write your piece on the lines
S — Specific: what exactly will I be able to do?	
M — Measurable: how will I prove it? (a score, a diagram, teaching a partner)	

A — Achievable: what effort will it take to reach it?	
R — Relevant: how does it connect to the big question above?	
T — Time-bound: by when?	
PUT IT TOGETHER — my S.M.A.R.T. goal in one or two sentences:	

Standard GC.28 — Tennessee's Three Branches

TN Academic Standard GC.28: Identify the functions of departments and agencies of the executive, legislative, and judicial branches in the state of Tennessee.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can identify the functions of the departments and agencies of Tennessee's executive, legislative, and judicial branches..

Lenses for this standard: Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

★ Tennessee Connection

This entire standard is Tennessee. The three stars on the state flag stand for the three Grand Divisions — East, Middle, and West — and Tennessee law spreads offices and representation across all three. The state's part-time citizen-legislature and its distinctive 'Tennessee Plan' for choosing appellate judges are features of Tennessee's own constitution and law (GC.28).

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

One building in Nashville houses lawmakers who meet only part of the year, a governor who runs dozens of agencies, and a court system with three different trial courts. How does one state divide all that power?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page

— GC.28

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Grand Divisions · Citizen Legislature · The Tennessee Plan

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you'll DO + how you'll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.28

 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Grand Divisions	The three legal regions of Tennessee — East, Middle, and West — recognized in state law and marked by the three stars on the state flag; the state balances offices and representation across all three.	Grandes Divisiones
Citizen Legislature	A part-time lawmaking body whose members keep regular jobs at home and meet for a limited number of 'legislative days'; Tennessee's General Assembly is designed this way, unlike the full-time U.S. Congress.	legislatura ciudadana
The Tennessee Plan	Tennessee's method for selecting appellate judges: the governor appoints them, and they then face yes-or-no 'retention' elections rather than contested partisan races — a merit-based approach that shapes the state court system.	el Plan de Tennessee

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
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LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Grand Divisions (grand dih-VIZH-unz); Citizen Legislature (SIT-ih-zen LEJ-is-lay-cher); The Tennessee Plan (TEN-eh-see plan).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Grand Divisions	_____	_____	_____	_____
Citizen Legislature	_____	_____	_____	_____
The Tennessee Plan	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You’ll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.28

 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio

WRITE: fill in the four boxes below in your own words.

SAY IT: explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.

DIAGRAM: sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.

PRIORITY TERM 1

Grand Divisions

· ES: Grandes Divisiones

Word-bank meaning to build on: The three legal regions of Tennessee — East, Middle, and West — recognized in state law and marked by the three stars on the state flag; the state balances offices and representation across all three.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Grand Divisions” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2

The Tennessee Plan

· ES: el Plan de Tennessee

Word-bank meaning to build on: Tennessee's method for selecting appellate judges: the governor appoints them, and they then face yes-or-no 'retention' elections rather than contested partisan races — a merit-based approach that shapes the state court system.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “The Tennessee Plan” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.28

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Grand Divisions

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: The Tennessee Plan

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell

Notes — GC.28 ~20 min

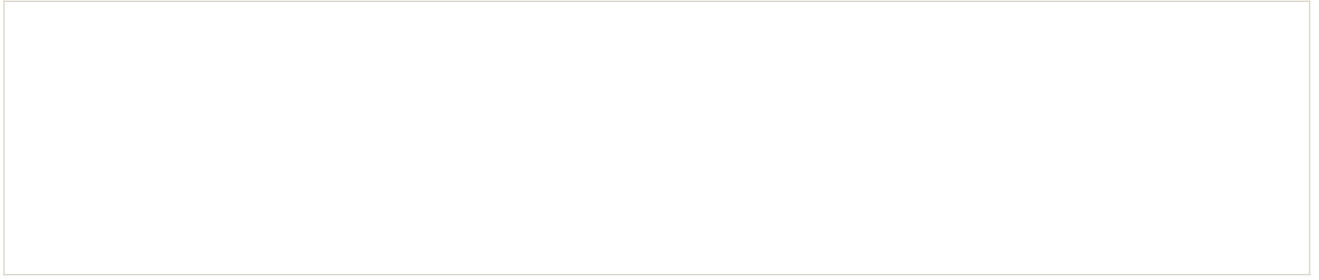
GC.28 — Tennessee's Three Branches • Lean Student Deck slides 2-8 • direct-teaching slides 4-6

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One Tennessee source that supports it?	
One real situation it applies to where you live?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.



Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.28

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Grand Divisions · Citizen Legislature · The Tennessee Plan

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

In Tennessee's trial-court system, which court is a court of equity, presided over by a Chancellor?

- A. Criminal Court
- B. Chancery Court
- C. Circuit Court

D. The U.S. District Court

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.28

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Grand Divisions	The three legal regions of Tennessee — East, Middle, and West — recognized in state law and marked by the three stars on the state flag; the state balances offices and representation across all three.
Citizen Legislature	A part-time lawmaking body whose members keep regular jobs at home and meet for a limited number of 'legislative days'; Tennessee's General Assembly is designed this way, unlike the full-time U.S. Congress.
The Tennessee Plan	Tennessee's method for selecting appellate judges: the governor appoints them, and they then face yes-or-no 'retention' elections rather than contested partisan races — a merit-based approach that shapes the state court system.

Break it into steps:

- 1) Name one cause or effect.
- 2) Give one piece of evidence.
- 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of tennessee's three branches was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of tennessee's three branches was Grand

Divisions: The three legal regions of Tennessee — East, Middle, and West — recognized in state law and marked by the three stars on the state flag; the state balances offices and representation across all three.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	
Evidence	
Explain	
Headline	

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.28

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Grand Divisions	
Citizen Legislature	
The Tennessee Plan	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- What does it mean that Tennessee's General Assembly is a part-time 'citizen legislature' with limited legislative days?
- How do Chancery, Circuit, and Criminal courts differ in what each one handles?
- What is the 'Tennessee Plan,' and how do appellate judges reach the bench under it?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.28 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Tennessee's government is built on the same three-branch design as the national government: the state constitution divides power into 'three distinct departments: Legislative, Executive, and Judicial.' The executive branch — led by the governor — runs the departments and agencies that carry out state law, from Education and Health to Safety and Transportation. The legislative branch is the General Assembly, a part-time 'citizen legislature' whose members hold regular jobs back home and meet for only a limited number of 'legislative days,' unlike the year-round Congress. To keep the state balanced, offices and representation are spread across Tennessee's three Grand Divisions — East, Middle, and West — the three stars on the state flag. The judicial branch is a layered court system: Circuit courts hear general civil and criminal trials, Chancery courts (led by Chancellors) decide matters of equity, and Criminal courts handle felonies in the larger districts, all beneath one Supreme Court. Tennessee's appellate judges reach the bench through the 'Tennessee Plan' — appointed, then facing yes-or-no retention elections. (Who is the current Chief Justice of the Tennessee Supreme Court? Look it up from an official source such as tncourts.gov — the five justices choose one of themselves, and it rotates.)

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Grand Divisions, Citizen Legislature. Read once for the gist, then again for

evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

- 1. What does it mean that Tennessee's General Assembly is a part-time 'citizen legislature' with limited legislative days?
- 2. How do Chancery, Circuit, and Criminal courts differ in what each one handles?
- 3. What is the 'Tennessee Plan,' and how do appellate judges reach the bench under it?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.28

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet Answer it from memory? ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1

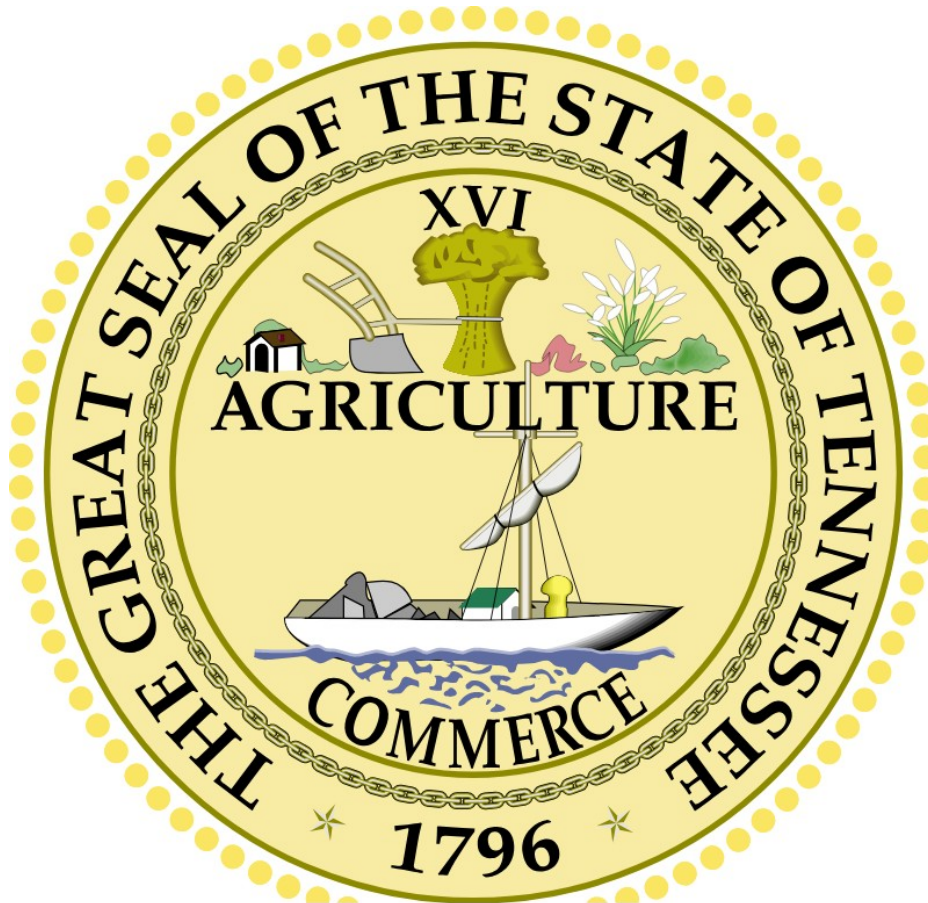
☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.28

🕒 ~15 min

Primary source (state seal) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



The Great Seal of the State of Tennessee • State of Tennessee • 1802 design

Source: Wikimedia Commons •

https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Seal_of_Tennessee.svg Public domain — U.S. state government insignia.

https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Seal_of_Tennessee.svg

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.28

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): _____

One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.28 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u7-gc28-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

The three stars on the Tennessee state flag stand for the state's three —

- A. branches of government
- B. Grand Divisions
- C. Supreme Court justices
- D. largest cities

[DOK 2 · item u1-gc28-dok2-tc · pre-field-test]

In Tennessee's trial-court system, which court is a court of equity, presided over by a Chancellor?

- A. Criminal Court
- B. Chancery Court
- C. Circuit Court
- D. The U.S. District Court

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” ·

“Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” ·
“What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate
whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from
THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK
and use evidence? If yes, it’s DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER)

— GC.28 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How does Tennessee govern itself at the state and local levels — and how do you take part?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Tennessee copied the federal three-branch design but added its own features — the Grand Divisions, a part-time citizen legislature, and the Tennessee Plan. Which of these three most shapes how the state is actually governed? Defend your claim with evidence.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence

(two specifics)	
Reasoning	

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.28

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4
TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.29 — Local Government in Tennessee

TN Academic Standard GC.29: Explain the differences among the types of local governments in Tennessee, including county, city, and metro governments, as well as the legal, fiscal, and operational relationships between them and the state government.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can explain the differences among county, city, and metropolitan governments in Tennessee and how they relate legally, fiscally, and operationally to the state..

Lenses for this standard: Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

★ Tennessee Connection

Tennessee's local map is its own: ninety-five counties, hundreds of cities, and a constitution that lets voters merge a city and its county into a single consolidated 'metropolitan' government — a structural model Tennessee helped pioneer. Study your own county and city to see which of these Tennessee structures governs your daily life (GC.29).

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

You live in a county. You might also live in a city. Both collect taxes, run services, and pass rules you must follow — yet neither could exist without permission from the state. Who really governs where you live?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page

— GC.29

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Unitary Government · Dillon's Rule · Metropolitan Government

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you'll DO + how you'll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.29

 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Unitary Government	A system in which a central government — here, the state — holds the primary authority and creates the local governments beneath it, which exercise only the powers the state grants. Tennessee is a unitary state.	gobierno unitario
Dillon's Rule	The legal principle that a local government has only the powers the state expressly gives it — the reason a Tennessee county or city cannot act beyond what state law allows.	Regla de Dillon
Metropolitan Government	A consolidated government that merges a city and its county into a single unit, authorized by the Tennessee Constitution and approved by local voters — one of the state's structural models alongside county and city governments.	gobierno metropolitano

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
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LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Unitary Government (YOO-nih-tair-ee); Dillon's Rule (DIL-unz rool); Metropolitan Government (met-ruh-POL-ih-tun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Unitary Government	_____	_____	_____	_____
Dillon's Rule	_____	_____	_____	_____
Metropolitan Government	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.29 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio

WRITE: fill in the four boxes below in your own words.

SAY IT: explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.

DIAGRAM: sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.

PRIORITY TERM 1

Unitary Government

· ES:

gobierno unitario

Word-bank meaning to build on: A system in which a central government — here, the state — holds the primary authority and creates the local governments beneath it, which exercise only the powers the state grants. Tennessee is a unitary state.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Unitary Government” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2

Metropolitan Government

· ES:

gobierno metropolitano

Word-bank meaning to build on: A consolidated government that merges a city and its county into a single unit, authorized by the Tennessee Constitution and approved by local voters — one of the state's structural models alongside county and city governments.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain
Write one sentence that uses “Metropolitan Government” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)
How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.29

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Unitary Government

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Metropolitan Government

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell

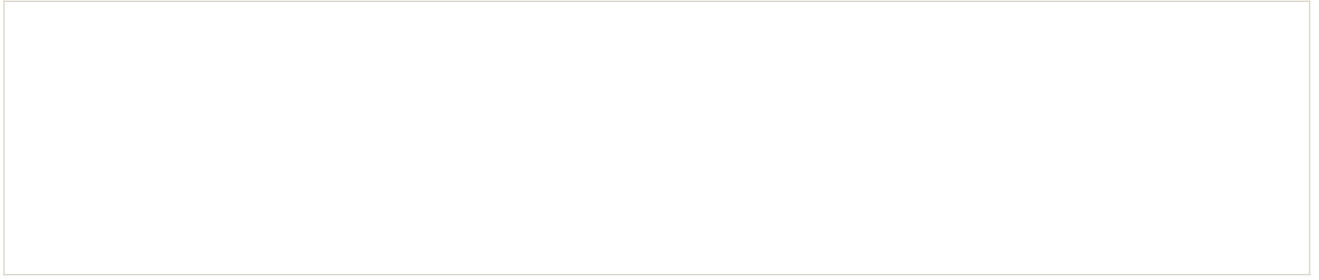
Notes — GC.29 ~20 min

GC.29 — Local Government in Tennessee • Lean Student Deck slides 2-8 • direct-teaching slides 4-6

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One Tennessee source that supports it?	
One real situation it applies to where you live?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.



Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.29

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Unitary Government · Dillon's Rule · Metropolitan Government

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

Tennessee is a unitary state. What does that mean for your county and city governments?

- A. They are completely independent of the state
- B. They report directly to the federal government
- C. They are created by the state and hold only the

powers the state grants them

D. They may set aside state law within their own borders

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.29

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Unitary Government	A system in which a central government — here, the state — holds the primary authority and creates the local governments beneath it, which exercise only the powers the state grants. Tennessee is a unitary state.
Dillon's Rule	The legal principle that a local government has only the powers the state expressly gives it — the reason a Tennessee county or city cannot act beyond what state law allows.
Metropolitan Government	A consolidated government that merges a city and its county into a single unit, authorized by the Tennessee Constitution and approved by local voters — one of the state's structural models alongside county and city governments.

Break it into steps:

- 1) Name one cause or effect.
- 2) Give one piece of evidence.
- 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of local government in tennessee was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of local government in tennessee was Unitary Government: A system in which a central government —

here, the state — holds the primary authority and creates the local governments beneath it, which exercise only the powers the state grants. Tennessee is a unitary state.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	
Evidence	
Explain	
Headline	

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.29

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Unitary Government	
Dillon's Rule	
Metropolitan Government	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- What does it mean that Tennessee is a 'unitary' state, and how does Dillon's Rule limit local governments?
- How do county, city, and metropolitan governments differ in structure and in the services they provide?
- Name the legal, fiscal, and operational ways your local governments depend on the state.

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.29 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Local government in Tennessee exists only because the state creates it. Tennessee is a unitary state: the state holds the primary authority and hands specific powers down to local governments, which — under 'Dillon's Rule' — may do only what state law allows. Within that system, Tennesseans are governed by several types of local government. Every part of the state lies inside one of its counties, and the voters of each county elect 'a legislative body, a county executive, a Sheriff, a Trustee, a Register, a County Clerk and an Assessor of Property.' Cities (municipalities) form to provide closer services — police, water, zoning — and use different structural models, such as a mayor-council form or a city-commission form. The state constitution also lets voters merge a city and its surrounding county into a single consolidated 'metropolitan' government. Legally, fiscally, and operationally these governments answer to the state: they are chartered under state law, may raise revenue only through taxes the state authorizes, and run programs the state funds and regulates. Look at your own county and city: which model does each use, and which services does each provide?

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Unitary Government, Dillon's Rule. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. What does it mean that Tennessee is a 'unitary' state, and how does Dillon's Rule limit local governments?
2. How do county, city, and metropolitan governments differ in structure and in the services they provide?
3. Name the legal, fiscal, and operational ways your local governments depend on the state.

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.29

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet Answer it from memory? ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1

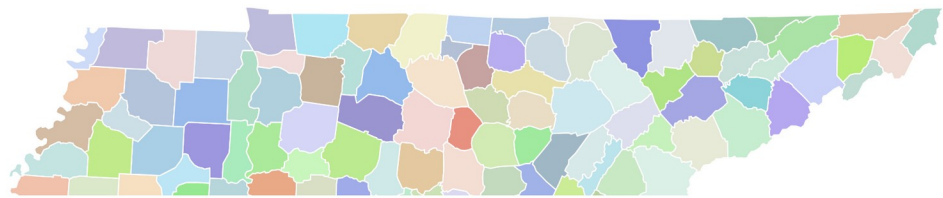
☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.29

 ~15 min

Primary source (map) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



Tennessee County Map (all 95 counties) · U.S. Census Bureau (cartographic boundary, derivative) · n.d.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau county boundaries, via Wikimedia Commons · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tennessee_county_map_cb_500k.svg
Public domain — derived from U.S. Census Bureau data (federal government work).
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tennessee_county_map_cb_500k.svg

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze
Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.29

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): _____

One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.29



RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u7-gc29-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

A government that merges a city and its county into one consolidated unit is called a —

- A. county commission
- B. unitary state
- C. metropolitan government
- D. Grand Division

[DOK 2 · item u1-gc29-dok2-tc · pre-field-test]

Tennessee is a unitary state. What does that mean for your county and city governments?

- A. They are completely independent of the state
- B. They report directly to the federal government
- C. They are created by the state and hold only the powers the state grants them
- D. They may set aside state law within their own borders

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” ·
“Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” ·
“What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate
whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”
Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from
THIS standard] + “using evidence.”
Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK
and use evidence? If yes, it’s DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER)

— GC.29 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How does Tennessee govern itself at the state and local levels — and how do you take part?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Opinion piece (Claim + Evidence + Reasoning): How can individuals best serve their communities and take part in the political process at the local, state, and national levels? Make a claim and defend it with specific examples of civic action a person your age could actually take.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence

(two specifics)	
Reasoning	

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.29

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4
TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.30 — Identify Your Current Officials

TN Academic Standard GC.30: Identify the current governor of Tennessee and the representatives in the General Assembly.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can identify the current governor of Tennessee and the state legislators who represent me, using official sources..

Lenses for this standard: Tennessee (T)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

★ Tennessee Connection

There is no more Tennessee-specific civic act than naming the people who govern you: your governor in Nashville and the senator and representative elected from your own district. This standard asks you to find and record them from official Tennessee sources — a skill you will use in every election (GC.30).

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Right now, a governor in Nashville and two legislators — one senator, one representative — make decisions for the exact spot where you live. Do you know their names? By the end of this lesson, you will have looked them up yourself.

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.30

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Governor · General Assembly · Constituent

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you'll DO + how you'll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.30

 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Governor	Tennessee's chief executive, elected statewide to a four-year term, who carries out state law, proposes the state budget, and sets policy priorities. Identify the current officeholder from an official source — it changes with elections.	gobernador(a)
General Assembly	Tennessee's state legislature, made up of a 33-member Senate and a 99-member House of Representatives, which writes and passes state law. These numbers stay the same regardless of who currently serves.	Asamblea General
Constituent	A person a legislator represents. You are a constituent of exactly one state senator and one state representative, determined by the district where you live.	elector / representado

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Pronunciations: Governor (GUV-ur-ner); General Assembly (JEN-ur-ul uh-SEM-blee); Constituent (kun-STIH-choo-ent).		

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Governor	_____	_____	_____	_____
General Assembly	_____	_____	_____	_____
Constituent	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You’ll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.30 ~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio

WRITE: fill in the four boxes below in your own words.

SAY IT: explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.

DIAGRAM: sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.

PRIORITY TERM 1

General Assembly

· ES: Asamblea

General

Word-bank meaning to build on: Tennessee's state legislature, made up of a 33-member Senate and a 99-member House of Representatives, which writes and passes state law. These numbers stay the same regardless of who currently serves.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “General Assembly” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2

Constituent

· ES: elector /

representado

Word-bank meaning to build on: A person a legislator represents. You are a constituent of exactly one state senator and one state representative, determined by the district where you live.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Constituent” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.30

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: General Assembly

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Constituent

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell

Notes — GC.30 ~20 min

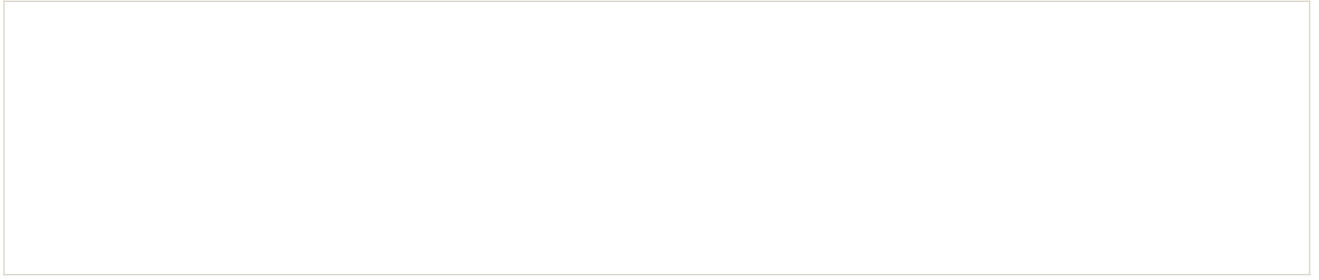
GC.30 — Identify Your Current Officials • Lean Student Deck slides 2-8 • direct-teaching slides 4-6

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One Tennessee source that supports it?	
One real situation it applies to where you live?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.



Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.30

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Governor · General Assembly · Constituent

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

To find out who currently represents you in the Tennessee General Assembly, the best source is —

- A. the official 'Find My Legislator' tool on the Tennessee General Assembly site (capitol.tn.gov)
- B. a rumor you saw on social media
- C. a textbook printed several years ago

D. a friend's best guess

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.30

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Governor	Tennessee's chief executive, elected statewide to a four-year term, who carries out state law, proposes the state budget, and sets policy priorities. Identify the current officeholder from an official source — it changes with elections.
General Assembly	Tennessee's state legislature, made up of a 33-member Senate and a 99-member House of Representatives, which writes and passes state law. These numbers stay the same regardless of who currently serves.
Constituent	A person a legislator represents. You are a constituent of exactly one state senator and one state representative, determined by the district where you live.

Break it into steps:

- 1) Name one cause or effect.
- 2) Give one piece of evidence.
- 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of identify your current officials was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of identify your current officials was Governor: Tennessee's chief executive, elected statewide to a four-year term, who carries out state law, proposes the state budget, and sets policy priorities. Identify the current

officeholder from an official source — it changes with elections.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	
Evidence	
Explain	
Headline	

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.30

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Governor	
General Assembly	
Constituent	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- Which official source would you use to find the current governor and his or her stated priorities?
- How many members serve in the Tennessee Senate and House, and how is each Tennessean represented in them?
- What steps would you take to identify your own Senate and House districts and the legislators who hold those seats?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.30 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

This standard is a civic-action task: identify the officials who represent you right now. Start with the executive — 'The Supreme Executive power of this State shall be vested in a Governor,' elected statewide to a four-year term. From an official source such as tn.gov, find the current governor's name and the priorities he or she has publicly stated (often in the annual State of the State address or the proposed budget). Next, the legislature: 'The legislative authority of this state shall be vested in a General Assembly, which shall consist of a Senate and House of Representatives.' Tennessee's Senate has 33 members and its House has 99. Every Tennessean lives in exactly one state Senate district and one state House district and is represented by one senator and one representative. Using your home address and the official Tennessee General Assembly 'Find My Legislator' tool at capitol.tn.gov, record your Senate district number, your House district number, and the names of the two people who currently hold those seats. Because officials change with every election, always confirm names, priorities, and districts from the official source — never from memory or from an old book.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Governor, General Assembly. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. Which official source would you use to find the current governor and his or her stated priorities?
2. How many members serve in the Tennessee Senate and House, and how is each Tennessean represented in them?
3. What steps would you take to identify your own Senate and House districts and the legislators who hold those seats?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.30

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet Answer it from memory? ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1

☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.30 ~15 min

Primary source (state flag) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



Flag of Tennessee · State of Tennessee (design by LeRoy Reeves, 1905) · 1905

Source: Wikimedia Commons ·

https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Flag_of_Tennessee.svg Public domain — official state flag design (1905).

https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Flag_of_Tennessee.svg

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.30

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): _____

One thing to revisit: _____

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.30 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u7-gc30-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

The Tennessee General Assembly is made up of which two chambers?

- A. the Senate and the House of Representatives
- B. the Cabinet and the Supreme Court
- C. the House of Lords and the House of Commons
- D. the Grand Divisions and the counties

[DOK 1 · item u1-gc30-dok1-tc · pre-field-test]

To find out who currently represents you in the Tennessee General Assembly, the best source is —

- A. the official 'Find My Legislator' tool on the Tennessee General Assembly site (capitol.tn.gov)
- B. a rumor you saw on social media
- C. a textbook printed several years ago
- D. a friend's best guess

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” ·
“Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” ·
“What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate
whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”
Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from
THIS standard] + “using evidence.”
Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK
and use evidence? If yes, it’s DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER)

— GC.30 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How does Tennessee govern itself at the state and local levels — and how do you take part?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: After looking them up from an official source, explain how you could contact your state senator or representative about an issue you care about — and why identifying your specific district matters for being heard.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two)

specifics)	
Reasoning	

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.30

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4
TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Your Tennessee Connection

★ **TENNESSEE CONNECTION**

This whole unit is the Tennessee Connection. Foundations traced government in the abstract; here it becomes concrete and local — the Capitol in Nashville, the three Grand Divisions marked by the three stars on the state flag, the ninety-five counties on the state map, and the specific legislators elected from your own district. Tennessee is not an example in this unit; Tennessee is the subject (GC.28–GC.30).

Reflect (RESPONSE CHOICE): How does a Tennessee connection change the way you understand a national idea? Answer by writing, recording, or diagramming.

Tennessee Civics Investigation

Tennessee is the classroom for this entire unit. Choose one and record it with a source: (a) name the three Grand Divisions and explain what the flag's three stars stand for; (b) identify which local-government model runs your own county; or (c) look up and record your current governor and your two state legislators from an official Tennessee source.

Prompt	Your findings
A Tennessee example	

Prompt	Your findings
connected to this unit	
One source I could check (library, TN Secretary of State, TSLA, a representative's office)	
How it connects to a standard in this unit	
One question I still have	

Progress Tracker & Cumulative Review

Track your Progress Check result for each standard and note one thing to revisit.

Standard	Progress Check (✓ / reteach)	One thing to revisit
GC.28		
GC.29		
GC.30		

Optional Extension Bank (higher-DOK, open to all)

Any student may choose an extension. These are EXTENSION, not a track.

GC.28: Tennessee copied the federal three-branch design but added its own features — the Grand Divisions, a part-time citizen legislature, and the Tennessee Plan. Which of these three most shapes how the state is actually governed? Defend your claim with evidence.

GC.29: Opinion piece (Claim + Evidence + Reasoning): How can individuals best serve their communities and take part in the political process at the local, state, and national levels? Make a claim and defend it with specific examples of civic action a person your age could actually take.

GC.30: After looking them up from an official source, explain how you could contact your state senator or representative about an issue you care about — and why identifying your specific district matters for being heard.

Reusable Toolkit & Source Library

Written Response Rubric (CER)

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains how evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 —	General	1 accurate	Partial link

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
Developing			
1 — Beginning	Unclear/missing	Missing/inaccurate	No reasoning

Source Library — full citations & clickable links

GC.28 — Tennessee's Three Branches

Tennessee Constitution, Article II, Section 1. Constitution of Tennessee, 1870. Constitution of the State of Tennessee. Public domain. <https://law.justia.com/constitution/tennessee/article-ii/section-1/>

Tennessee Constitution, Article VI, Section 1. Constitution of Tennessee, 1870. Constitution of the State of Tennessee. Public domain. <https://law.justia.com/constitution/tennessee/article-vi/section-1/>

GC.29 — Local Government in Tennessee

Tennessee Constitution, Article VII, Section 1. Constitution of Tennessee, 1978. Constitution of the State of Tennessee. Public domain. <https://law.justia.com/constitution/tennessee/article-vii/section-1/>

Tennessee Constitution, Article XI, Section 9. Constitution of Tennessee, 1953. Constitution of the State of Tennessee. Public domain. <https://law.justia.com/constitution/tennessee/article-xi/section-9/>

GC.30 — Identify Your Current Officials

Tennessee Constitution, Article III, Section 1. Constitution of Tennessee, 1870. Constitution of the State of Tennessee. Public domain. <https://law.justia.com/constitution/tennessee/article-iii/section-1/>

Tennessee Constitution, Article II, Section 3. Constitution of Tennessee, 1870. Constitution of the State of Tennessee. Public domain. <https://law.justia.com/constitution/tennessee/article-ii/section-3/>

Whose Government? Perspectives on Power in Tennessee

This section traces how power is arranged and shared across Tennessee government — divided among three branches, balanced across three regions, and layered from the state down to your own county and city. It is Government Hack–authored instructional synthesis grounded in this unit's sourced record — not a primary source.

Separation of Powers, State Level

Tennessee splits authority into three departments — legislative, executive, and judicial — the same design as the national government, applied to the state (GC.28).

Balancing the Grand Divisions

East, Middle, and West Tennessee each carry distinct histories and interests; the state deliberately balances offices and representation across all three (GC.28).

A Unitary State, Layered Locally

Authority flows from the state down to counties, cities, and consolidated metropolitan governments — each one created by, and answerable to, the state (GC.29).

Representation and Civic Action

Government reaches all the way down to your own district and your own officials — and this unit asks you to identify them, contact them, and take part (GC.30).

Unit Reflection

Return to the unit’s big question: How does Tennessee govern itself at the state and local levels — and how do you take part? Write a final claim with two pieces of evidence from different standards.

Part	Write here
My claim	
Evidence 1 (standard:)	
Evidence 2 (standard:)	
Why it matters today	